

The Sixth Workshop on Immersive Sickness Prevention

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1 INTRODUCTION

The Sixth Workshop on Immersive sickness Prevention (WISP), held in conjunction with IEEE VR 2025 in Saint-Malo, France, is intended to foster discussion between researchers, developers, and practitioners interested in addressing cybersickness, one of the most significant usability issues in VR. Cybersickness remains one of the most significant challenges facing the virtual reality industry. Although immersive technologies have been advancing rapidly, their rate of public adoption has been slowed by the fact that many users experience physical discomfort during or after the use of VR devices, with symptomatic characteristics similar to motion sickness. Furthermore, studies have consistently shown that motion sickness disproportionately affects women, and concerns have been raised about the existence of inequitable barriers for engaging with immersive media.

This workshop invites researchers, developers, and practitioners working on immersive technologies to share insights and advancements in understanding and mitigating cybersickness. The workshop includes research papers that report study results, novel interaction techniques, or technological interventions aimed towards understanding and mitigating cybersickness, as well as position papers describing early-stage concepts, preliminary results, or case studies from industry. Through engaging discussions and knowledge sharing, the workshop aims to foster improved design practices, novel technological solutions, and a deeper understanding of the factors contributing to virtual reality sickness.

2 WORKSHOP FORMAT

The workshop is a half-day, in-person event featuring a variety of activities, including paper presentations, lightning talks and a keynote talk from an invited expert and informal discussion between participants. One of the main goals of the workshop is to foster a strong community of researchers, developers, and practitioners interested in addressing cybersickness, by leveraging the networking opportunities provided by face-to-face interactions.

2.1 Paper Presentations

This year, we solicited primary research papers describing study results, novel interaction techniques, or technological interventions aimed toward understanding and mitigating cybersickness for users of immersive systems. We also welcomed position papers describing early-stage concepts, preliminary results, or case studies from industry. Our goal is to create an engaging, collaborative space where attendees can share bold ideas, receive constructive feed-

back, and spark fresh research directions. All papers were reviewed by at least two expert external reviewers.

This year the workshop will bring together four papers addressing various aspects of cybersickness in immersive environments. The accepted works span experimental platforms, prediction methods, experimental paradigms, and systematic reviews.

Research Platforms and Tools: The first work [2] introduces an open-source platform specifically designed to study cybersickness in multiplayer XR environments. This work addresses a critical gap in understanding how team-based interactions influence cybersickness, providing researchers with a customizable testbed for investigating both individual and collective dynamics. The next work [3] evaluates advanced machine learning approaches for predicting detailed cybersickness symptoms. The study provides valuable insights into the limitations of multi-task learning compared to traditional single-task approaches in cybersickness prediction.

Prediction Methods: The third paper presents [1] an innovative digital solution that replicates traditional VIMS-inducing mechanisms in virtual reality. Through a controlled study with 30 participants, the research validates a new tool for both inducing and studying cybersickness mitigation methods.

Literature Analysis and Future Directions: the fourth paper [4] examines the understudied domain of cybersickness in 360°-video viewing. Through analysis of 52 articles, the review identifies four key factor categories affecting cybersickness and highlights critical research gaps, particularly in understanding the unique characteristics of immersive experiences constrained to 3 degrees of freedom such as 360°-videos.

Each accepted paper is given approximately 15 minutes for presentation. Additionally, all workshop papers are submitted to the IEEE Digital Library, ensuring broader accessibility and fostering ongoing dialogue within the community.

2.2 Lightning Talks

In addition to paper presentations, the workshop features a lightning talk session designed to ignite discussions and facilitate the exchange of ideas within the WISP community. This session provides a platform for researchers to share innovative perspectives, ongoing projects, emerging research directions, and thought-provoking questions. Lightning talks were solicited through an open call for participation as well as invitations extended to authors of recent publications from leading publication venues for VR research, including ACM CHI, ACM VRST, IEEE TVCG, and IEEE ISMAR. By showcasing cutting-edge research in a concise format, these talks allowed attendees to gain insights into the latest advancements in cybersickness research without the need to attend multiple major conferences. Additionally, they provided authors with an opportunity to broaden the reach of their work and engage in meaningful discussions with a diverse scientific audience.

2.3 Keynote Talk

The workshop features a distinguished keynote address by Dr. Victoria Interrante, offering a broad perspective and forward-looking vision on cybersickness research. This hour-long session provides an opportunity for an in-depth exploration of key challenges, recent

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advancements, and future directions in the field. To ensure attendees are well-prepared, the workshop website publishes the keynote title, speaker bio, and abstract in advance, providing valuable context and background information ahead of the event.

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